CODE OF ETHICS
AND
BUSINESS CONDUCT

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1. INTRODUCTION

This Code of Conduct applies globally to ensure world-wide integrity and consistency in corporate values and behaviour. At the same time, it respects the local customs and traditions.

2. COMPLYING WITH LEGAL REQUIREMENTS

2.1. COMPLYING WITH LAWS

We will act within the law, our licensing and authorizations obligations, and any other regulations.

We will conduct our business as responsible corporate citizens, and we will follow the applicable legal framework of the country in which we operate by the letter of the law and in spirit. All employees are expected to function in line with this principle.

Employees are expected to know and to understand the legal obligations applicable while performing their duties and discharging their responsibilities on the job. Ignorance cannot be an excuse for violation of law.

Considering the fact that our businesses are spread over multiple locations, a common approach should be adapted, to the extent possible, in matters that impact us at more than one location.

Any unlawful means of whatever nature to overcome difficulties in the operation or implementation of legislation is expressly prohibited and discouraged.

2.2. COMPETING FAIRLY

We are committed to legal and ethical competition.

We will use our resources, knowledge, and expertise to our competitive advantage, but we will avoid undermining the operation of free markets and we will respect the rights of others to carry on their business. We will also avoid putting undue pressure on customers in ways that may reduce or remove their ability to choose between services of competitors.

We will respect out competitors' proprietary information. We will also respect our competitors' rights.

We will not try to secure an advantage by ridiculing the competition. Whilst our information memoranda would never be misleading in any manner, it would not fail to highlight our competitive strengths.

We shall support the development of laws that promote, encourage, or result in, fair competition.

3. ACTING WITH INTEGRITY

3.1. MAINTAINING HIGHEST STANDARDS OF INTEGRITY

We are committed to maintaining the highest possible standards of integrity and ethics in every sphere of activity, and we will abide by the rules and regulations of the organisation.

3.2. CONFLICT OF INTEREST

We will avoid or declare conflicts of interest that may lead, or be seen to lead, to divided personal loyalties.

Employees are expected to protect and nurture the Company's interests all the time. A conflict of interest also includes conflicts between the Company's interest and employees' interests outside the Company. It could arise from employee having a large shareholding in a competing organisation, participating in the business and management of another organisation in any manner, spending work time on other things, or acting as a supplier or competitor to the Company.

Employees are expected to remain independent in any decision that they may be required to take and should disclose any interest – personal, professional, academic or business – which may arise directly or indirectly through their relatives, which may conflict with their responsibilities.

Employees must avoid any form of activity that would result in a conflict of interest situation or a potential conflict of interest situation, such that the ability of the employee to perform objectively or impartially could get impaired.

We will refrain from engaging with any person or firm where we have reasons to believe that such engagement is likely to create a conflict of interest for such person or firm opposite his pre-existing obligations with others.

Note: In the event of any doubt pertaining to conflict, discuss with your manager to agree on the way forward.

3.3. INDUCEMENTS

We will not offer or accept gifts, hospitality or other inducements, which influence a decision, or engage in any form of bribery. Employees are expected to report any such incident that they may be witness to.

3.4. BRIBERY

The Company does not espouse the payments or receipt of gifts or bribes for business or financial gain. As a corollary, employees or representatives of the Company are expected not to do anything that could give an impression that the Company could be influenced in this manner.

3.5. GIFTS AND HOSPITALITY

It might be customary, at times, to exchange unsolicited gifts during the traditional festive seasons or during certain corporate events. These will be restricted to promotional or advertising material or such items that are customary or considered to be prudent or of a symbolic nature by the management, having regard to the nature of the business, the type of markets in which the Company is operating and the event being observed. It would however be unethical and incorrect to give any gift with the intent to derive any benefit in return.

Employees are expected to routinely report gifts and hospitality amounting to more than 100 USD to the line manager, and also contact him/her in case of any doubt.

3.6. FACILITATION PAYMENTS

The Company does not welcome or encourage facilitation payments. Such payments may be made only when they are legal, small, customary in the circumstances, and are used to secure an outcome to which the Company is legally entitled. In situations where payment is unavoidable, the amount must be openly recorded and employees should seek reimbursement under the normal approval procedures. Where it is practical, employees are expected to consult local management and agree to the payment in advance.

3.7. SUSPECTED FRAUDULENT BEHAVIOUR

Any act of commission or omission which is detrimental to the business of the company i.e., bribery, fraud, pilferage, theft, etc., will be termed as misconduct. Any such suspected fraudulent behaviour is liable to be investigated and the employee/s concerned is/are liable to face appropriate disciplinary action including dismissal from the services of the company.

3.8. OUTSIDE EMPLOYMENT OR ANY OTHER TYPE OF ASSOCIATION

Employees are expected to devote their full time attention to the business of the Company and not take on any assignment either directly or indirectly without proper authorisation.

3.9. COMMUNICATION

We will be truthful, helpful and accurate in our communication.

Effective communication is vital to avoid misrepresentations, misleading impressions or untruths. All communication material shall be prepared against this backdrop and will be adequately backed by documentation to support any claim or statement made.

Information posted on the Company's website(s) will be governed by the same standards as are applicable to other communication material.
We will, on a timely basis, provide reliable and meaningful information about our products, services, operating results and other activities to legitimately interested persons and as may be required by law, subject to considerations of the legal requirements, cost and confidentiality.

Given the sensitivities involved, specific persons or groups will be authorised to communicate on specified matters, and no other person would be expected to communicate in an out-of-turn manner on those matters.

We will maintain communication with our employees through our internal communication systems and by the consultative process.

3.10. COMMITMENTS

We will ensure that others have confidence in the commitments we make on behalf of the Company, and that agreements are suitably authorized.

Decisions, commitments, or business agreements made by us as individuals are seen by the outside world as having been made by the Company. Our reputation as a trusted company is built by having a track record that justifies confidence in these commitments. There could be decisions we cannot make as individuals - because we are not authorized or because we need the support of others. These internal agreements are important as they ensure that we involve people with expertise and experience and help the company allocate the resources needed to meet external expectations.

All decisions will be taken in terms of the applicable 'Delegated Authority'. With that authority, also comes a duty to involve anyone else who may have responsibility for that decision, and to make sure that everything has been accurately recorded.

3.11. MAINTAINING CONFIDENTIALITY OF INFORMATION

We will protect the confidentiality of company, employee and customer information.

Revealing confidential company information could undermine the Company's competitive advantage. Employees are expected to be aware of the Company's security classification system. Employees are also expected to be very careful when discussing confidential Company business in public places. It is expected that employees are sure of whom they are speaking to before disclosing information that might be commercially sensitive.

Disclosure of information should only be made to the extent necessary to achieve our commercial goals. Employees are expected to treat e-mail with the same professionalism and confidentiality as other more 'traditional' forms of communication as E-mails can have legal consequences too.

The nature of our business means that we hold a lot of information about people. This is vital for the relationship between the company and our customers and employees - for providing a service to our customers and paying our people. To ensure that we continue to have this privilege we must respect the trust placed in us, and only use the information for the purpose for which it was entrusted.

Additionally, there is an increasing amount of data protection legislation throughout the world, driven by people's concern that information might be used for the wrong purposes. If we breach this legislation for any reason not only would we break the law, but we would also damage the Company's reputation and the trust that people have placed in the Company.

4. PROTECTING ASSETS

4.1. PROTECTION OF COMPANY ASSETS

We will protect our brand, physical, financial and intellectual assets.

We are responsible as individuals for the security and protection of the assets used in our job. This includes the proper accounting for the use of any company resources. It is expected that Company property – equipment and intellectual property rights such as patents, trademarks, copyrights, designs, strategies, plans, trade secrets and similar items that are not in the public domain – will be used only in the course of, and for, Company business, with proper care and safeguards.

Innovation and well-reasoned risk taking shall be supported, but performance will be demanded. Employees shall have no rights or lien over any inventions that arise in the course of employment.

One of our most valuable assets is the 'EmpireOne' brand and its reputation. A strong brand is essential for sustainable success, especially in fast-changing and highly competitive markets. The Company's brand must be protected with as much care as our buildings or equipment. Products, services or marketing communications that are not consistent with the meaning of the brand, bad press publicity, or improper use of the logo undermine our brand and competitiveness.

We will not infringe the intellectual property rights of others. For example, we respect copyright in third party software.

4.2. MANAGEMENT AND MITIGATION OF RISKS

We will assess and manage risks to our business.

The way a business manages its risks is critical to its success. These risks cover commercial, financial, operational and compliance risks. There is also increasing external pressure to demonstrate that a business takes appropriate steps to control unnecessary risks. We should make decisions about acceptable risks and levels of risk as part of everyday business.

Individual operations should have a system for managing risk. That means firstly identifying and assessing potential risks to achieving our objectives, then deciding which risks to accept and how to manage them.

5. RELATING WITH STAKEHOLDERS

5.1. CUSTOMERS

Our products and services shall be technologically competitive and whilst fulfilling the needs of our customers, shall offer the best possible value to our customers such that we become the customers' first choice for quality and service. No false or misleading claims shall be made whilst marketing our products or services. Our service standards shall be of the highest possible order.

Mutually beneficial relationships of an enduring nature will be built with customers. Our response to the needs and expectations of customers shall be speedy, courteous and effective. Customer complaints and warranties will be attended to the full satisfaction of the customer.

5.2. EMPLOYEES

We want to attract, develop and motivate the best people. We will create a work environment that is open, honest and unprejudiced and which encourages people to achieve their full potential. We will value people's individual and team contributions, and offer opportunities to share in the company's commercial success.

We will recruit, employ and reward on ability and contribution. We will provide opportunities for personal growth and professional development and engage in appropriate communication and consultation with employees. We will promote a healthy lifestyle.

5.3. PARTNERS

We will cultivate a global network of collaborative and mutually beneficial alliances. We will respect partners' customs and traditions, and be honest and ethical in our dealings.

We will work with partners in the creation of successful ventures, which have high standards of integrity and business practice. We will use our values and principles in dialogue with other organizations and in considering new and existing relationships.

5.4. SUPPLIERS

We will value the diversity of our suppliers. We will work with them in innovative ways that create added value for our customers and trading partners.

We will have a fair procurement process, administering tendering and contracting procedures in good faith.

5.5. COMMUNITY

We will contribute to the well-being of the societies in which we operate through our business activities and the skills of our people.

We will maintain the highest level of integrity while respecting local laws, customs and traditions. We will work with community and other organizations to support non-profit making activities that benefit wider society. We will use our influence to reinforce the liberating and empowering potential of technology.

6. MAINTAINING AN EQUITABLE AND SAFE WORKPLACE

6.1. DIVERSITY

We will treat all individuals fairly and impartially, without prejudice, and never tolerate harassment in any form.

We are committed to developing a working culture that is fair and 'inclusive' - enabling all employees to make their distinctive contributions to the benefit of the business. We are also determined to ensure that we extend this same openness to our suppliers, business partners and all our customers. We expect our managers to exercise leadership in this field by discouraging prejudice and by role modelling appropriate behaviour.

6.2. EQUAL EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITY

We will be an “equal opportunity” organization that prohibits discrimination or harassment based on race, colour, religion, national origin, sex, age, sexual orientation, marital status, citizenship status, or disability.

6.3. SEXUAL HARASSMENT

The Company prohibits any kind of sexual harassment. Sexual harassment includes making unwelcome advances, sexual flirtations or propositions, continual or repeated verbal abuse of a sexual nature, graphic verbal commentaries about an individual's body, sexually degrading words used to describe an individual, humour and jokes about sex or gender specific traits, sexual innuendo, display in the workplace of sexually suggestive objects or pictures, and transmission of sexual messages via voice mail, regular mail, e-mail or the Internet or Intranet.

6.4. HEALTH AND SAFETY

We will care for the health and safety of each other, our products, and of our operations.

We are responsible for making sure that the way we carry out business does not harm the health and safety of our own people or anyone else affected by our activities, products or services.

6.5. ENVIRONMENTAL COMPLIANCE

We will minimize the potentially harmful effects of our activities on the environment.

We are committed to protect and preserve the environment. We will endeavour to reuse rather than dispose whenever possible. We will also promote recycling and the use of recycled materials.

6.6. HUMAN DIGNITY

We are committed to protecting and enhancing the human dignity of all those engaged with our company.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I, _____, hereby acknowledge receipt of the Code of Ethics and Business Conduct on _____. I hereby attest that I have read and understood the entire document and agree to be bound by the foregoing rules, terms, and conditions of this Code. I further agree that this Code may be amended by company Management from time to time and, subject to prior notice. I likewise pledge compliance with the new rules or policies which may be promulgated henceforth.

_____
Employee's Printed Name over Signature

DOCUMENT HISTORY

Version	Date	Author (function)	Reviewed by	Approved by	Nature of changes
1.0	October 2024	Jude Michael David, Compliance Manager	Cielo V. Cupta, VP for Operations	Cielo V. Cupta, VP for Operations	First Integrated issue
1.1	March 1, 2026	Apple Mag-usara, HR Generalist Dolley Campugan, HR Generalist	Rhea Alao, Finance & Accounting Director Mark Valencia, Site Director Marc Louise Castanares, Site Manager	Giovanni Yap, Executive Director Anthony Aragon, HR Director	Revision of Code of Conduct and Discipline